

Employee Engagement Study: Voice of the Employee

Product Planning

How they feel they add value to the organization:

- Understanding the North American market
 - Gather insights and deliver to PP in HQ
 - Give recommendations re:
 - Price
 - Features
 - Portfolio Mgmt
- Product marketing
 - Formulate value proposition on products for account teams to pitch to carriers
 - Educate others on products
- Portfolio Management
 - Maximize revenue and market share
- Planning the future
 - Long-term view (18+ months)
 - Balancing company's capabilities with the market (what is the market doing, where can we use our capabilities to fill a gap/capitalize)
- End-to-End view
 - Provide advice to account teams and marketing on life-cycle management

How well they feel they are aligned with other departments, management, and HQ:

- Dale gives them his vision approximately every 2 weeks, more often with Hero devices
 - Dale is somewhat inconsistent in his expectations of the group
 - Sometimes wants a short-term focus
 - Sometimes wants a long term focus
- Nick is good at communicating what he knows
- Nick seems to encourage a longer term focus
- They're not sure what Kevin thinks
- The trend is increasingly shorter-term focus
- HQ is becoming a black hole
 - Secret devices means they are not sharing info
- The account teams don't use them properly
 - They feel like consultants to the account teams, PP is not empowered to give direction to them
 - And the account teams do their own thing

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- Example, Verizon has its own PP Manager on their account
- But Dale holds Product Planning accountable when something doesn't meet expectations
- They have no MBO's or KPI's that measure their impact or value to the organization, so they feel stuck in the middle of opposing forces, and not sure that they provide much value

What gaps or barriers they feel hinder their ability to add value and feel valued:

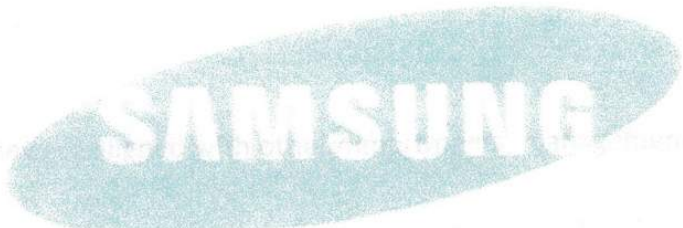
- Marketing needs to be more involved in understanding the products
- Lack of HQ feedback re: STA PP proposals
 - They send presentations and they go into the HQ black hole
 - Do they understand the content?
 - Do they use it?
 - What parts do they use, find useful? What do they not?
 - It's difficult to influence HQ or find the sweet spot if they don't know how HQ uses their work
 - Morale issues for newer employees who are especially discouraged by lack of feedback
 - Morale issues because it's difficult to show how they provide value to the organization
- No centralized ownership of the P&L for a product in the PP group
- Barriers have gotten worse as the secrecy of the devices has increased
- Travel to HQ has reduced
 - Great for families, personal lives
 - But bad for building working-level relationships, especially for new people.
- Unsure how Conrad's team fits in, the integration seems poorly planned
 - What is their R&R?
 - What are they working on?
 - How do we work together?

What actions they feel are needed to maximize their value:

- Need Kevin to be an Executive influencer at HQ and in STA for PP
 - Gather insights
 - Inject STA PP opinions to HQ PP
 - Champion STA PP to HQ, Dale and Organization
- Need to hear feedback from HQ about the proposals they submit to HQ
- Need translators in HQ meetings/meetings where Korean is spoken
- Good collaboration with marketing; collaboration with Account teams varies by team; HQ is a black hole

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- Lack of a solid launch process given reduced visibility into M and Note, and presumably future secret devices
- Clarity of R&R for new members
 - Structure
 - Process
 - Where does everyone fit in?
- Who owns the R&R to pitch the value proposition to the carrier?
 - Sometimes there is lack of coordination b/w PP and carrier teams, so they are pulled in at the last minute to present to the carrier and feel unprepared
 - It worked well before when the Account Team was responsible for current year and PP for future year
- The Account teams need to pull in PP more
 - Account teams are missing important points
 - Lack consistent PM message
- Hero products need 1 clear owner of P&L, and they think Dales sees it as the PP teams, but they have no authority over it—get clarity



SAMSUNG

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Concept Creation (Conrad's Former Team)

How they feel they add value to the organization:

- Provide the disciplines related to Innovation
 - Industrial design
 - Research
 - Creative resource
- They are like an internal IDEO
- Develop ways to make STA/Samsung do things differently
- Create innovations to influence HQ; bring new ideas to help Samsung stay #1
- Be an independent voice
- Enhance user experience for Samsung ecosystem ; conduct UX research in the field
- Long term focus
- Provide North American perspective on products/experience
- Input to HQ
- Product Enhancement

How well they feel they are aligned with other departments, management, and HQ:

- HQ has been centralizing product innovation over past 18 months; about 12 months ago, HQ seemed to lose interest in their input
 - They conduct pre-launch testing and feedback
 - Report issues to HQ
 - But they never receive feedback on whether the issues are addressed (they have to figure it out themselves by checking the next version of the device)
- Team consists of individual contributors unless pulled together by leadership
- They don't know the big picture anymore (Omar and Conrad used to tell them)
- Budgets for research, testing, project have been cut
- Seems to be a lack of alignment in STA and with HQ about their purpose
- Focus has changed to short-term sales focus
- Omar provided direction, due dates, and frequently interacted with them and used their talent
- Dale told them they a dream team, and should be separated from day-to-day responsibilities
 - But now, current management wants them focused on driving sales
- No visibility into what projects are being worked on by the team; everyone works independently
- Don't see the big picture/vision because have been purposely separated from day-to-day to protect creativity
 - Has backfired to where they are now seen as out of touch

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- Referred to as “not grown up” because they have been separated from the day-to-day business operations, and they find it insulting to be referred to that way
- Their supposed to be different, but keep being forced into the traditional; Company needs to make up its mind
- Team is not being recognized for accomplishment with Allshare
- Other teams use them to create “pretty powerpoints” or help them make “pretty graphics” to visualize their ideas; they find this a massive underuse of their skills

What gaps or barriers they feel hinder their ability to add value and feel valued:

- They know there's a lot of work available, but there has been a lack of leadership to assign/coordinate resources
- Lack of KPIs and metrics to show their value, accomplishments, and impact
- Lack of staff meetings and communications
- Lack of vision/direction
- Nick is trying to learn, but otherwise they feel there is very little understanding of their group by other leaders
- They hear they have a bad reputation for turning down and/or not completing work but they feel that's unfair (don't know what is being referred to) and they feel that it's management's job to help fix that impression
- Each person is in a vacuum/no collaboration
- No one has their back anymore (previously was Omar) who marketed their capabilities and value
- When perceived as consultants, they don't get credit for the impact they make; not getting recognized for their accomplishments
- Team is not aligned to other teams; it seems that no one appreciates the design process and how they fit into the value chain—sales isn't the only part of the value chain

What actions they feel are needed to maximize their value:

- Clarify the mission of the group and Roles/Responsibilities of each function and person
- Need a leader to promote the unique value of the team; build or create opportunities for them to deliver value
- Need to have more input to SVP Choi of Mobile Design
- Need leadership to MBO's/Measures of their accomplishments
- Need leadership to allocate resources, projects, and pull the team together
- If they are being expected to focus on the near term, and helping to increase North American sales, then they need to be included in relevant Marketing and Sales meetings
 - Use new knowledge to find opportunities to provide value
- Other teams need to understand what they do (beyond pretty powerpoints)

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- Define whether they should be focused on long-term /short-term or both
- Need clear reporting structure; some people are held responsible for the actions of their peers
- Can't envision a long-term career here; is there a career path for designers at STA?

The Samsung logo, consisting of the word "SAMSUNG" in white capital letters inside a blue oval.